

Master of Lies

Director in the Shadows

“Spies flock to my cause. With them, I bend the fortunes of my opponents to my will.”

Setup

1. Take the Spies and put them near you in plain sight of all players.
2. Choose a color then take the Player Screen, Leaders (dice), Alliance Tokens, and one Card Marker of your color. Place everything behind your Player Screen.
3. Place one of your Alliance Tokens on the start of the Honor Track.
4. Keep one of your Alliance Tokens for each player (including yourself) and put the rest back in the box.
 - a. You should start with 6 Alliance Tokens in a 6-player game.

Checkpoint

1. Find one copy of the following Investments and put them face-up in front of your Player Screen:
 - a. DAMAGE REDEMPTION
 - b. SILVER-TONGUE
 - c. BROWN NOSE
 - d. MARKET NICHE
2. Place a non-player die, with value 2, on each of your Investments, denoting their level.
3. Move four of your Leaders out in front of your Player Screen, each with level 2. The rest of your Leaders cannot be used yet.
4. Find one copy of the following Law, place one of your Card Markers on the top of the card, and place it face-up at the front of the Law Queue.
 - a. UNREASONABLE DISTRACTIONS
5. Find one copy of the following Scheme and put it in your hand.
 - a. CORPORATE TAKEOVER

Checkpoint

1. Give 1 Spy to each player.

“This is your starting Spy. Keep it behind your screen since Spies are private information.”

2. Shuffle the 3 decks thoroughly and place them near you in plain sight of all players.

“There are three kinds of cards in this game: Investments, Laws, and Schemes. Investments can be built to provide major upgrades to your Province. Law cards can be added to the Queue where they have a good chance of becoming an Edict and forcing all players to follow new, mostly permanent restrictions. Scheme cards can be secretly submitted to harm other players without anyone knowing exactly who was responsible.”

3. Deal 2 cards from each deck to each player, unless the player already has a card in their hand.
 - a. You start with a Scheme, so deal yourself 2 Investments, 2 Laws, and only 1 Scheme.

“I will give each of you two cards from each deck to start the game with. These make up your hand. You get to keep these through the game and may be able to play them. Keep them behind your shield so no one knows what you’re planning.”

Round 1

Action Phase

1. **Flatter** to gain the King’s Favor and 3 Coins from the Royal Bank.

“I want to start the next round, so I am going to gain the King’s Favor by Flattering the King. Apparently, he is so impressionable that he sends me home with some money from his coffers. I gain half my Leader’s level in Coins, rounded up, so I will take 1 Coin from the Royal Bank. My Brown Nose Investment also gives me two extra Coins when I Flatter, so I’ll take those from the Royal Bank as well. Oh, by the way, the King’s Favor gives the holder 1 Honor at the end of the game!”

2. **Undermarket Monetize** 3 non-Scheme cards for 1 Coin using MARKET NICHE.

“I want some more Coins, but I don’t have any Commodities to sell. I do have some cards I don’t want, so I am going to Monetize them to the Undermarket. Normally, I have to discard 7 minus the current Market Rate minus 1 for using the Undermarket in cards (currently 4 cards) for 1 Coin, but my Market Niche card improves that rate by 2, so I only have to discard 2 cards per Coin. I can gain up to 2 Coins with this leader, but I want to keep some of these cards, so I will only take 1 Coin. Since this is a Court action, I take my Coin from the Free Bank, and no one else may use this action for the rest of the round. I’m only selling ideas, so this does not affect the Market Rate.”

3. **Promote** a leader to Level 3.

“I want a more powerful leader for better actions, so I will use the Promote action and increase his level immediately by 1. Unfortunately, I won’t get to use him until the next round.”

4. Pass

“I have no more leaders left, so I will pass for the rest of the round.”

Report Phase

- When the Chief Scribe prompts you, set the Deliberated Law to 2.

“I think we need to focus more on fighting the Greeks and less on our own little empires, so I’m going to cap everyone at 5 Investments. This won’t be active until the end of the round though.”

Round 2

“I have the King’s Favor, so I get to choose who will start the round. I choose myself, of course.”

Action Phase

- At some point in the next round, subtly **scheme** against the Warmonger with one of your Allies (Chief Scribe or Crime Lord) as the Receiver.
 - Find your Corporate Takeover scheme card from your hand and grab one card marker for the Warmonger and one for your chosen Ally from your pouch.
 - Put the Warmonger’s card marker on the top of the scheme card (the Target of the scheme) and your Ally’s on the bottom (the Receiver of the scheme).
 - Put the marked scheme card into the pouch with all the rest of the card markers.
 - Put your Spy into the pouch.

1. **Court Buy** with 2 Coins.

“I need some Commodities, and now is a decent time to buy them.”

2. **Court Sell** for 2 Coins.

“Since the Market Rate has dropped so conveniently, I’m going to sell my Commodities for a profit.”

3. **Infiltrate** 3 Spies using SILVER-TONGUE.

“I’m going to purchase some Spies, just like you do Troops. I’ll buy 2 Spies for 2 Coins, and I get to buy 1 extra Spy because of my Silver-Tongue Investment.”

4. **Deploy** 2 Troops.

Report Phase

Almost done! You’re doing great.

Round 3

Action Phase

1. **Flatter**
2. **Infiltrate**
3. **Postpone**
4. **Negotiate** with the Chief Scribe

Report Phase

You made it! Nice score!